

4. Source: Meeting with the Country Director of Food Without Border in Beta, passed on by informants to local tribal leadership.

Food Without Borders (FWB) has been present in the country for over twenty years. Its Country Director, a seasoned professional with a wide network of connections, expressed shock over the detention of Health for All's staff in Beta Town. He's deeply concerned that such incidents might set a dangerous precedent and endanger the security of many humanitarian workers in the country. The team from Health for All confirmed that their primary concern is the safe release of their staff as HfA will be leaving Beta soon. The team explains that due to funding constraints, HfA is compelled to shift most of its resources to Gamma, discontinuing operations in Beta and many other poorly funded operations.

The FWB Country Director very much understand this situation as his organization faces similar financial challenges. Despite these limitations, he believes it's implausible to exit Beta under the prevailing circumstances. In his view, while the ongoing humanitarian crisis in Beta remains severe, the global media's portrayal of the war in Gamma makes the crisis in Beta

less enticing for donors. Instead, government donors are inclined to support military and humanitarian operations in countries like Gamma, much more visible in the press and government circles. This scenario underscores the politicization of humanitarian aid, leaving relief workers like us to navigate these complexities in Beta.

For FWB, the top priority is the safe release of the detained staff in Beta Town. The Country Director suggested that for Health for All to see their staff safely returned, they will need to strike a compromise with the tribal leaders and the community, such as maintaining some medical activities at the hospital. He highlighted the growing unrest in places like Beta Town. With the diminishing employment opportunities for local guards and tribespeople formerly associated with different factions, some are exploring alternative income sources. Sustainable safety for humanitarian staff in rural areas can only be achieved with the backing of tribal leaders and the local population. This perspective should be taken into account as Health for All evaluates their next steps regarding the detained staff.

FWB pledges its full support to ensure the staff's release, including leveraging its rapport with tribal leaders. Having significantly aided the community during food security crises, especially among children, FWB's commitment remains unwavering.